



Ryan Zernach Senior AI Systems Engineer • LLM Infrastructure & Product Engineering

Portfolio: [Ryan.Zernach.com](https://ryan.zernach.com) • Email: Ryan@Zernach.com • [LinkedIn](#) • [GitHub](#) • [Remote](#)

HIGHLIGHTS

- Distributed systems engineer with 10+ years of experience in Payments, Agents, Mobile Apps, MLOps, & AI Infrastructure
- Scaled CellarChat™ tool-calling agent to 1M+ active members, complete with CI/CD LLM evaluation scoring pipelines
- Designed distributed backend systems that support autonomous AI-powered eCommerce VoIP payment workflows
- Completed Gauntlet AI engineering fellowship with 2% acceptance rate and mastered the art surfing the wave of AI
- Boosted mobile app ratings to 4.9★ (10k+ reviews) & lifted recurring revenue by 25%+ w/ Apple Pay subscriptions
- Awarded Top 10 of 10,000 international projects in 2024 NASA Space Apps hackathon with AI Voice Assistant

TECH STACK

Programming Languages

• Python, TypeScript, Rust, Go, Java, C#, Ruby, Swift, Kotlin, Bash, JavaScript, PHP, C++, Objective-C, R, Solidity

AI Systems & Machine Learning

• LLMOps, RAG, Agents, MCP, Evaluations, Semantic Kernel, LangChain, ML Pipelines, Computer Vision, Vector Search, Embeddings, Neo4j Graphs, PyTorch, TensorFlow, Scikit-Learn

Platform & Backend Engineering

• Node.js, FastAPI, Nest.js, Express, .NET Core, Microservices, OpenAPI, REST, GraphQL, WebSockets, Webhooks, gRPC, Kafka

Data & Persistence

• PostgreSQL, SQL, NoSQL, Redis, Vector Databases, ETL, Snowflake, Graph Databases, Entity Relationships, Caching, BigQuery, PySpark

Cloud Infrastructure & DevOps

• AWS, Azure, GCP, Cloudflare, Docker, GitHub Actions, Terraform, Kubernetes, CI/CD, CloudOps, Blue/Green, DNS, Networking

Front-End & Product Engineering

• iOS, Android, Swift, Kotlin, React, React Native, Expo Router, Next.js, Redux, Streamlit, Animations, Design, User Feedback

Distributed Systems & Operations

• Queues, Redis, RabbitMQ, Analytics, Pub/Sub, Linux, Airflow, Event-Driven Architecture, VoIP, Observability, Admin Systems, WebRTC, Rate Limiting, Horizontal Scaling, Load Balancing, Cron

Security, Identity & Compliance

• AuthN, AuthZ, OAuth, Identity, Role-Based Access Control, Secure Systems Design, SSO, API Security, Secrets, JWT

Payments, Communications & Integrations

• Stripe, Apple Pay, IAP, Billing, Subscriptions, Wallets, Twilio, SMS, Push Notifications, HTTP APIs, Marketing Tech, Email SMTP/IMAP

Blockchain & Web3

• Ethereum, Solana, dApps, WalletConnect, MetaMask, Polygon, Solidity, Smart Contracts, Ethers.js, Tokens, ERC-20, ERC-721

EXPERIENCE

Fractional AI Systems Engineer • United States • Remote

Jul 2025 - Present

- Building AI-enabled product and automation systems across payments, mobile apps, and semantic intelligence infrastructure
- Dockerized semantic intelligence layer around open-source software plugins for managing Plaid financial data and tax filings
- Published TranslateWallpaper, a cross-platform mobile app powered by LLM-generated language-learning wallpapers

AI Engineer (Full-Stack) • CellarTracker • Seattle • Remote

Aug 2023 - Jul 2025

- Scaled agentic CellarChat™ to 1M+ international members with Python back-end & TypeScript front-end
- Architected OpenAPI tool-calling pipeline, fine-tuning pipeline, LLM evaluations, & observability systems
- Integrated intelligent ML-powered recommendations for world's largest online database of wine reviews
- Maintained C#/ .NET layer, Microsoft Azure infrastructure, and CI/CD pipelines for international engineers
- Helped to boost app store ratings to 4.9★ average with 10,000+ verified 5-star ratings on iOS and Android
- Embedded Apple Pay subscriptions in the React Native app to generate additional 25%+ recurring revenue
- Improved user's experience of cellar management CRUD workflows to improve consistency and reduce taps
- Implemented animations, barcode scanning, activity feed posts, support ticket refactors, & OCR image search
- Streamlined the Redux store for fast, efficient, and persistent global state management between app sessions
- Migrated legacy support ticket system from Active Server Pages (ASP) to safer, type-friendly Express framework
- Rebuilt the React Native app's analytics implementations for tracking critical user interactions and app behavior
- Built contextual AI workflows connecting cellar inventory, tasting history, wine metadata, and recommendations

Mobile Engineer (Full-Stack) • Archlife Industries Software • Miami • Remote Sept 2021 - Aug 2023

- Delivered eTrading exchange for stocks/crypto, including public leaderboards and copy friend's portfolio distribution
- Engineered companion admin web dashboard to monitor AWS Terraform infrastructure and mobile app analytics
- Constructed core mobile app functionality, including: Plaid connections, trending investors, & suggested stocks
- Built social network features, such as direct chat, user profiles, posts, likes, emojis, & threaded comments
- Wrote the data-visualization logic for viewing and comparing the performance of different stocks/crypto
- Transitioned eSports React Native codebase from JavaScript to TypeScript for long-term maintainability
- Iterated on group chat features, push notifications, & native calendar sync to improve user satisfaction
- Remedied bluetooth connection & map performance for Swift iOS/iPad telecommunications app

Data Science & Machine Learning Tutor • edX • Vanderbilt, UC Berkeley, +24 others • Remote July 2020 – Sept 2021

- During pandemic, taught 900+ online college students Python, machine learning, TypeScript, websites, & databases
- Managed busy schedule of remotely teaching 30+ university students per week in 1:1 setting (one hour per person)
- Dozens of universities were subscribed to my employer's curriculum and online tutoring resources for students

React Web Developer (Full-Stack) • Georgia Hybrid Landscaping • Alpharetta, Georgia Oct 2015 – Jan 2019

- Engineered uploading videos/images, survey questions, pricing proposal, & processing payments
- Migrated websites from PHP to React, and processed \$500k+ in gross sales within three years
- Managed online eCommerce payments analytics, Google AdSpend, and email campaigns
- Configured outbound marketing email campaign schedulers & listeners using IMAP/POP
- Setup observability dashboards for payments, marketing, analytics, API logs, & admin

Payments Systems Intern (Card Processing) • Cost Plus Processing • Alpharetta, Georgia Sept 2012 – Jan 2013

- Worked with merchant processing systems & payment gateways to understand critical financial flows
- Analyzed end-to-end card transaction lifecycles (interchange rates, risk) across payment networks
- Built foundational knowledge of payment infrastructure, interchange fees, & transaction routing

EDUCATION & TRAINING

AI Engineering Fellowship (G3) • Gauntlet AI • Remote • Austin, TX 2025

- Mastered how to command agents, automate workflows, and 100x enterprise-grade software engineering
- Harnessed the power of RAG, multi-agent systems, OpenAPI, and MCP to build agentic automations

Data Science & Machine Learning Bootcamp • Lambda School • Y Combinator • Remote 2020

- Recommendation Engines, Computer Vision (CV) Models, Time-Series Forecasting, Natural-Language Processing
- Python, SciKit-Learn, PySpark, Data Engineering, PostgreSQL Databases, Back-End APIs (Flask / FastAPI)

Turfgrass & Landscape Management • University of Georgia (NALP) • Athens, Georgia 2015

- Design Principles, Science of Grass, Outdoor Business Management, Landscape Architecture

Computer Science & Mathematics Coursework • Georgia Southern University • Statesboro, Georgia 2012

- Visual Basic, Calculus, C, C++, R, Statistics, Data Structures, Programming Principles, Linear Regression

CERTIFICATIONS

2025 • Gauntlet AI Engineering Fellowship (G3)

2024 • NASA Space Apps Hackathon Finalist

2022 • Ethereum Blockchain Developer

2020 • TensorFlow Computer Vision

2020 • AutoML Pipelines (DataRobot Academy)

2019 • Google Cloud Platform GCP Developer

2019 • AWS Microservices Cloud Practitioner

2019 • Y Combinator Startup School